

Not Assessable

Unit 6

Ethics

Unit 6: Ethics (Not assessable)

The Trolley Problem

Why study ethics?

What is ethics?

Ethical frameworks

Unit 6: Ethics (Not assessable)

- 1. Explain the importance of ethics in personal and professional life**
- 2. Understand the main three types of ethical framework**

... but this is just a fun interlude and is not assessable.

The Trolley Problem

What is a Trolley?

‘American’ for a tram or light rail

The Trolley Problem

There is a runaway trolley barrelling down the railway tracks

Ahead, on the tracks, there are five people tied up and unable to move

The trolley is headed straight for them

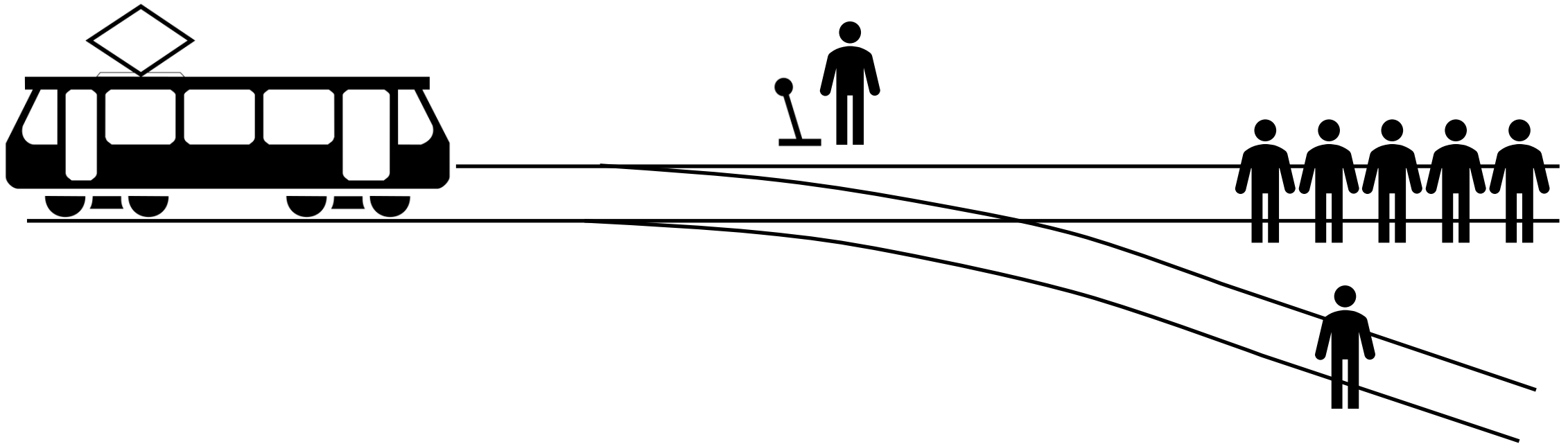
You are standing some distance off in the train yard, next to a lever

If you pull this lever, the trolley will switch to a different set of tracks

However, you notice that there is one person on the side track

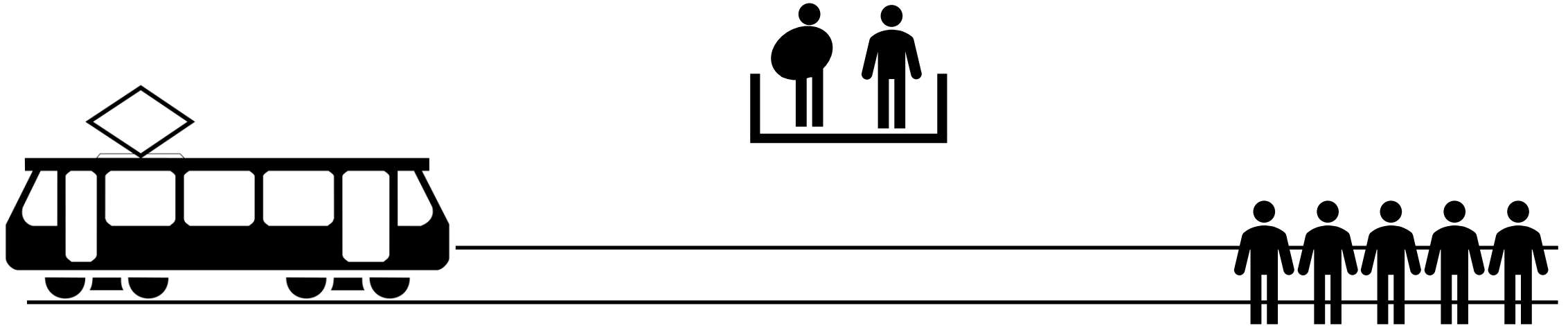
The Trolley Problem

The Switch



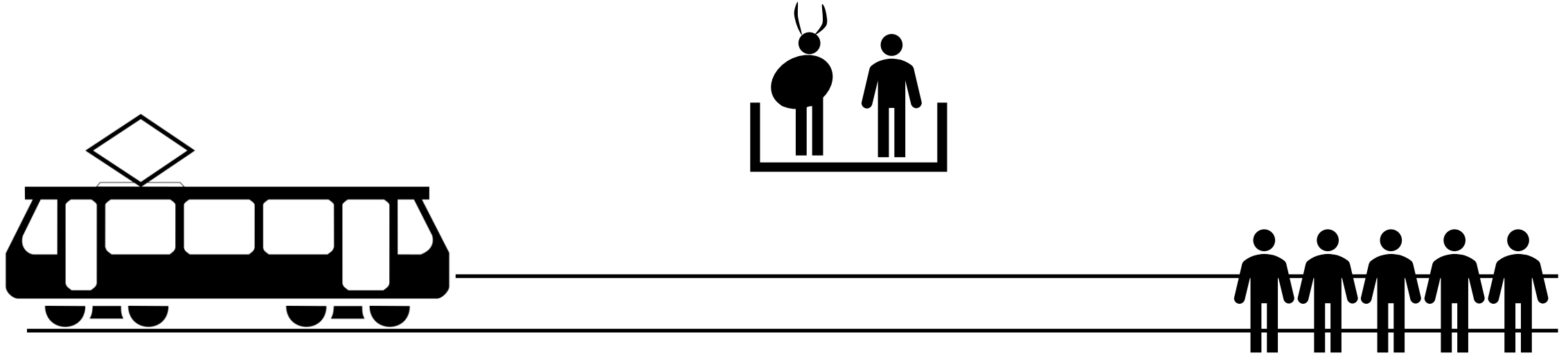
The Trolley Problem

The Fat Man



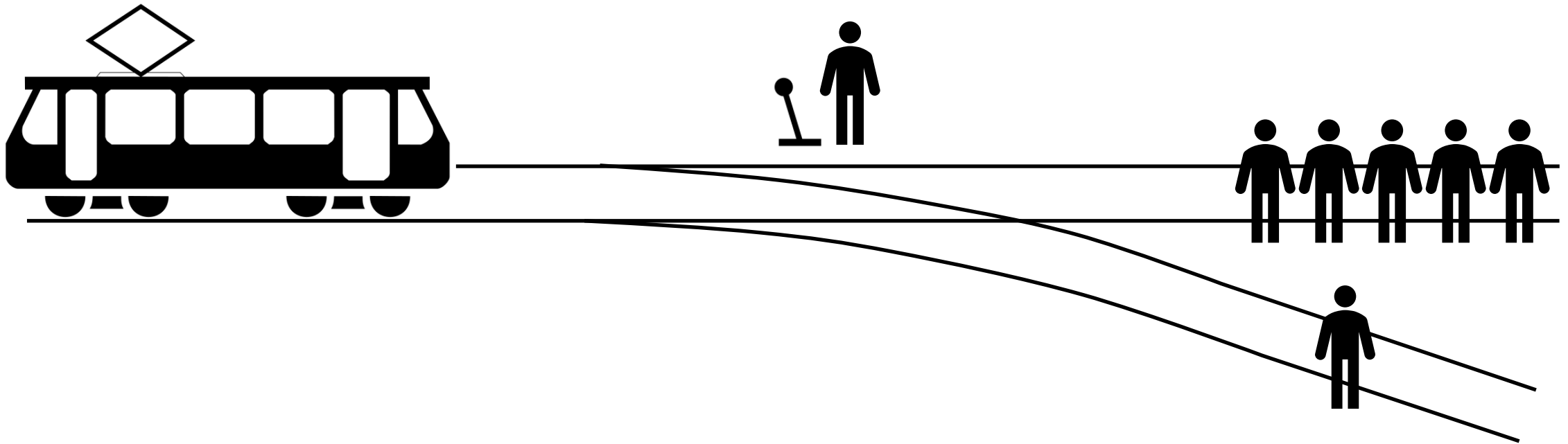
The Trolley Problem

The Fat **Villain**



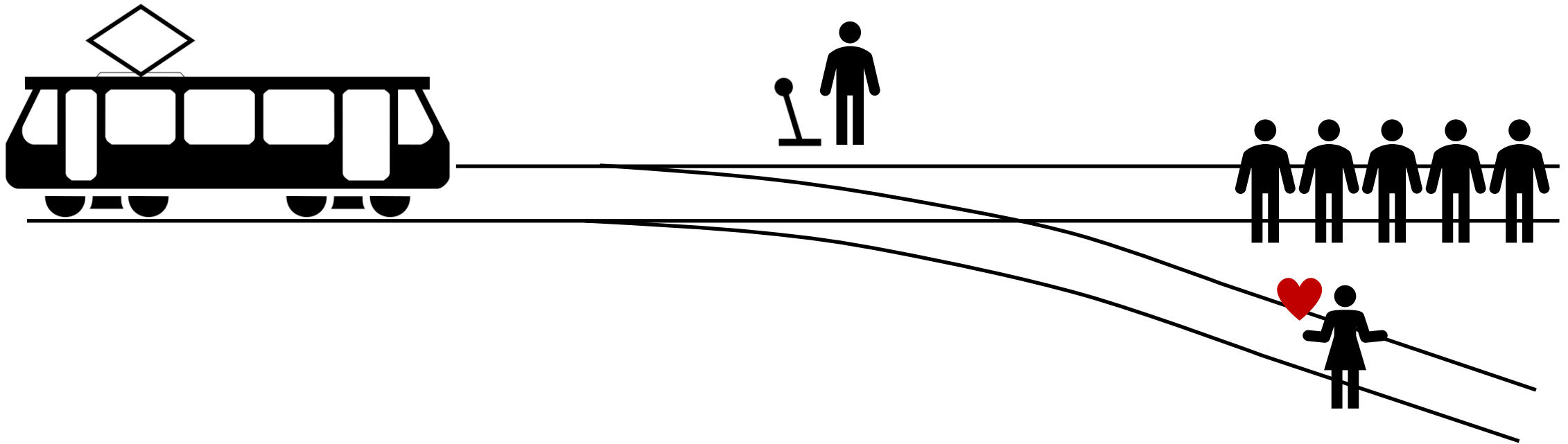
The Trolley Problem

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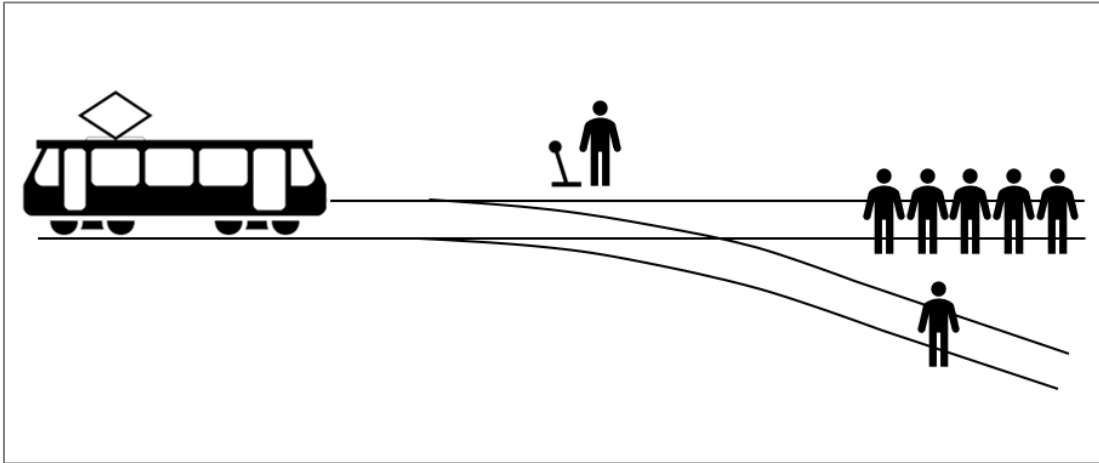


The Trolley Problem

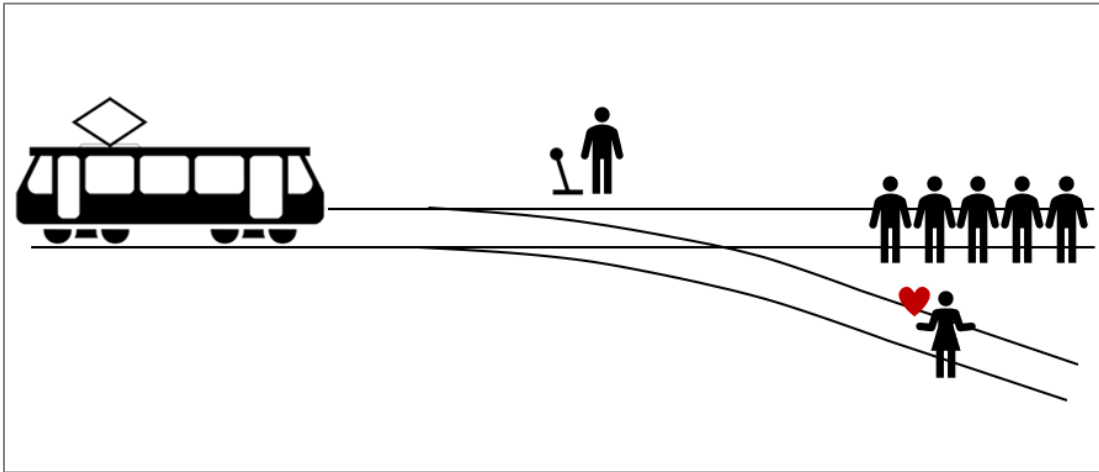
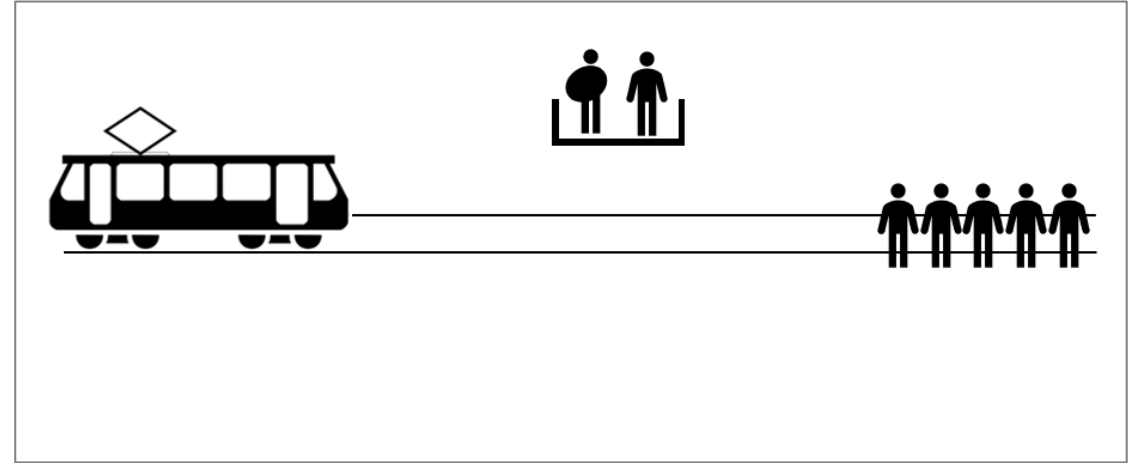
The **Loved One**



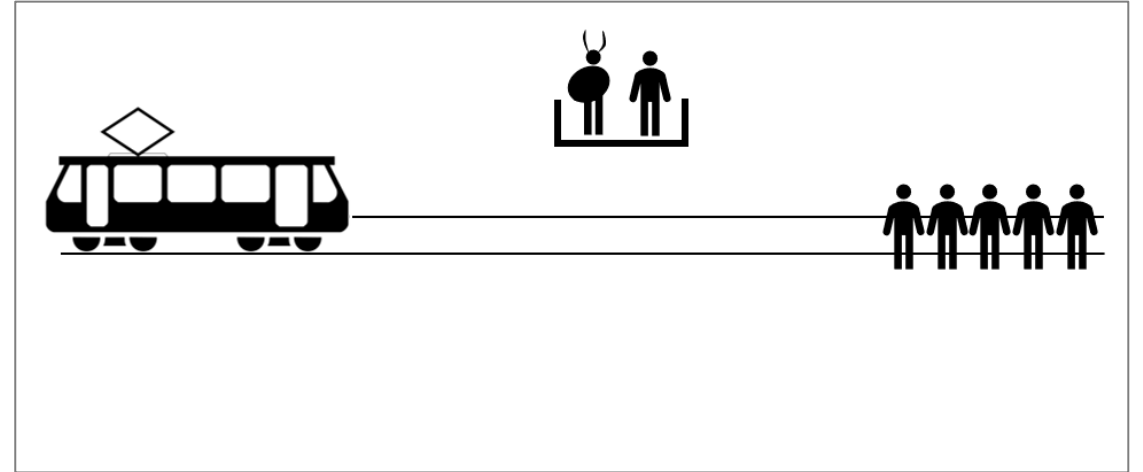
The Switch



The Fat Man



The Loved One



The Fat Villain

A few observations

Working out 'the right' thing to do can be tricky

... clearly articulating the reason 'why it is right' can be even trickier

Do we even care about ethics and what is 'right' any more?

Is going with 'gut feeling' or 'instinct' the right thing to do?

How do you balance rationalism with emotions?

Is doing what is 'best for me' the right thing to do?

Would what is 'right' change if I was tied up on the line?

The Diamond

... has many facets.

The sparkle is only visible as you turn it around.

When faced with an ethical dilemma

Making an ethical decision involves

looking at the dilemma from different angles

by testing it with different ethical frameworks

... but it is easy to FREEZE up

The Trolley Problem in 'The Good Place'



Eleanor
Morally-Challenged
(Kristen Bell)

Chidi
Moral Philosophy
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Michael
Alien (?)
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#TheGoodPlace #nbc
The Trolley Problem | The Good Place | Comedy Bites

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DtRhrfhP5b4>

Why Study Ethics?

1. Because it is an awesome topic!

2. If you don't like it ...

... you are an uncultured barbarian!

3. To surround ourselves with great thinkers

Socrates

Aristotle

Kant

Bentham

Mills

4. It challenges us to analyse how we think

... so that we can understand ourselves better

5. We can learn about our culture and family

6. It helps us to understand others

... with empathy

7. Shared beliefs about ‘what is right’

... help to create ‘trust’ in relationships

8. Ethics helps us build mental muscles ...

... to fight temptations and solve dilemmas

9. Sometimes we need a bit of help ...

... to do what we know we should do!

10. Past failures in basic ethical conduct

11. Required study for financial advisers

12. From Socrates himself

Philosopher from Ancient Greece (469 – 399BC)

**“The unexamined life
... is not worth living”**

We want financial advisers like this ...

... and not like this!

... or this!

What is Ethics?

What is ethics?

We make choices and decisions every day

What makes them morally good and what makes them bad?

What makes a decision right and what makes it wrong?

Ethics is the analysis of what makes something right or wrong

It asks the question, “What ought one do?”

... which is not quite the same as “What should I do?”

Potter Stewart

former Associate Justice of the Supreme Court of the United States

“Ethics is knowing the difference between ...

what you have a right to do ...

and what is the right thing to do.”

Simon Longstaff

founder of The Ethics Centre (UNSW)

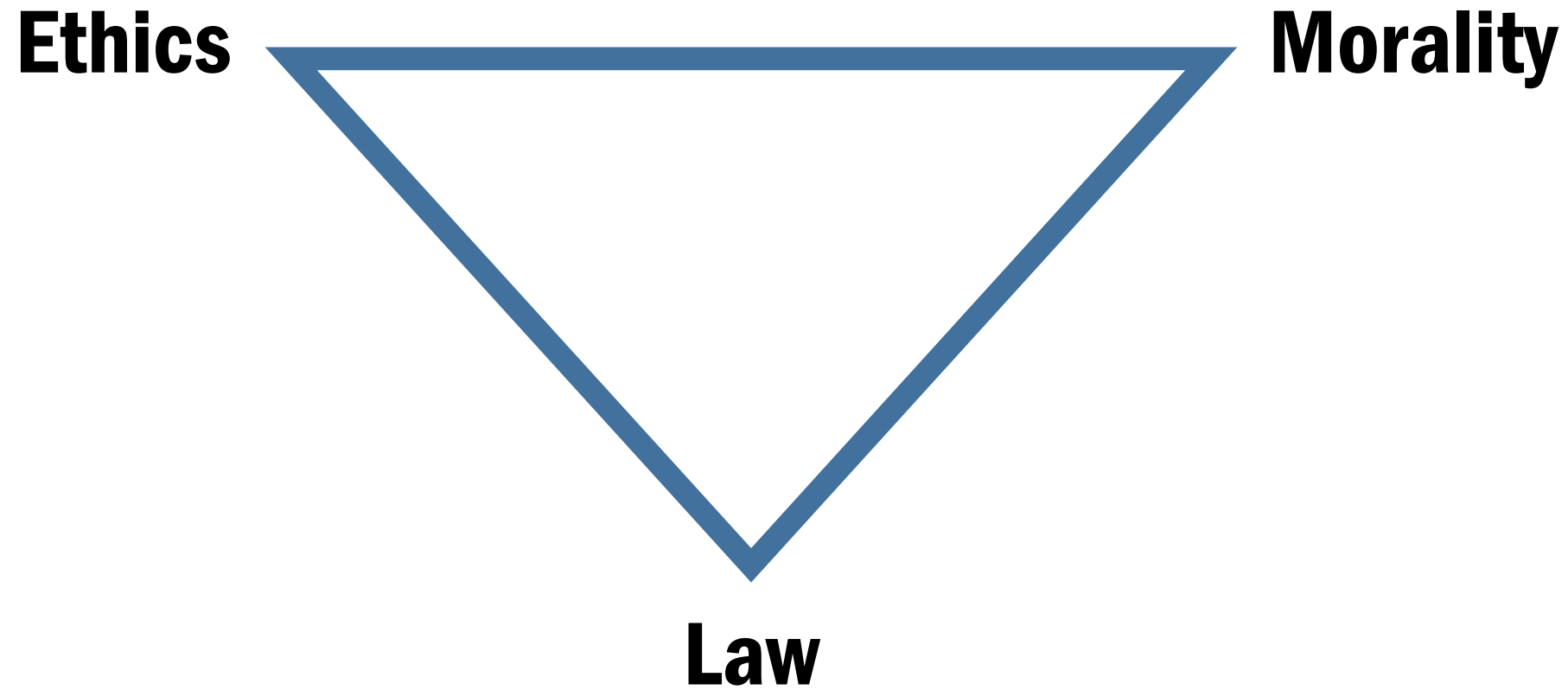
“Ethics ... is about struggling to develop a well-informed conscience.

It’s about being true to the idea of who we are and what we stand for.

It’s about having the courage to explore difficult questions.

It’s about accepting the cost.”

What is the difference?



Ethics v Morality

Ethics is the analysis of what makes a decision morally right or wrong

It is the conversation you are having with yourself asking ...

“What ought one do in this situation?”

“What would be the right or wrong things for me to do here?”

Morality is what influences the ultimate decision

It is the ‘voice’ that responds to that conversation!

... it can have a religious, cultural or family ‘voice’

Ethics v Law

The law has a lower standard

Ethics pursues much higher standards of behaviour

The law has a narrower focus

Ethics focuses on both public and private life

The law focusses on what not to do

Ethics helps focuses on both what not to do and what to do (what is right and good)

The law can be in conflict with ethics

Such as a journalist going to jail for refusing to reveal a source to a judge
... or protester demonstrating about an authoritarian government

Some fancy terms

1. Normative ethics

Identifying the moral standards or ‘norms’ by which we can operate and live

... the values and principles that are ‘right’ and ‘good’

2. Meta-ethics

Explores where our ethical principles come from and what they mean

“Are there moral values that are absolute, universal and independent of human conventions?”

“What motivates us to be moral?”

3. Applied ethics

Attempts to resolve controversial real-life issues in the world

“Is it right to restrict someone’s rights if they refuse vaccination?”

“Should we adopt nuclear energy to mitigate the damage from climate change?”

Some fancy terms

4. Ethical relativism

Ethical principles differ between individuals, cultures and circumstances

Helpful to recognise why individuals have different ethical systems

5. Ethical absolutism

There are universal principles that apply across all cultures and circumstances

Helpful for professions (like the financial planning industry) with a fiduciary duty

... one involving 'trust' between the client and the adviser

... requiring the adviser to place the needs of the client before their own needs

Ethical Frameworks

Ethical Frameworks

- 1. Virtue Ethics**
- 2. Deontology**
- 3. Consequentialism**

1. Virtue Ethics

Aristotle

Good actions are the ones that reveal us to be of excellent character

Our choices should demonstrate virtues

Such as courage, loyalty or wisdom

Our actions shape our character

What we do determines who we become

Every time we are honest ... we are more likely to show honesty when it is tough

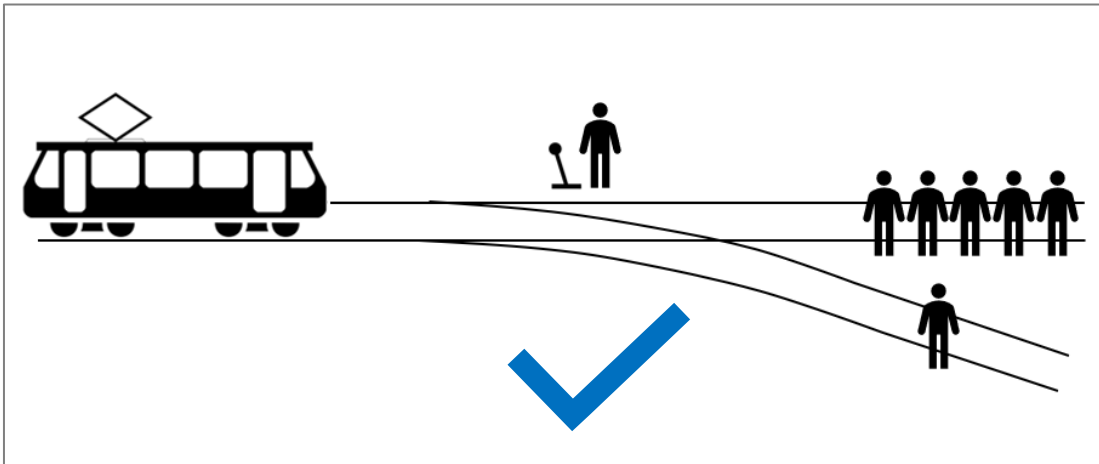
Every time we lie ... in moments when it is crucial to tell the truth we will be less able to do so

Act in a way that is consistent with ‘best version of yourself’

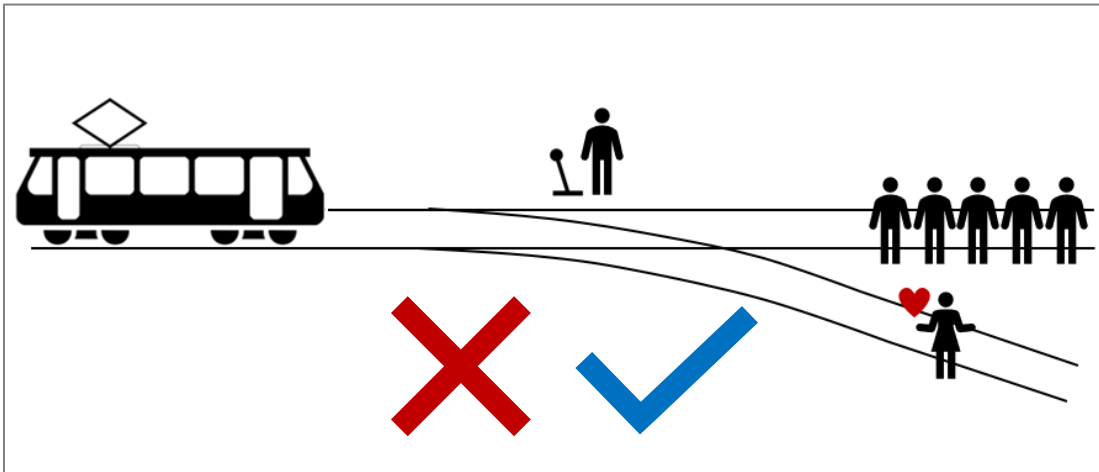
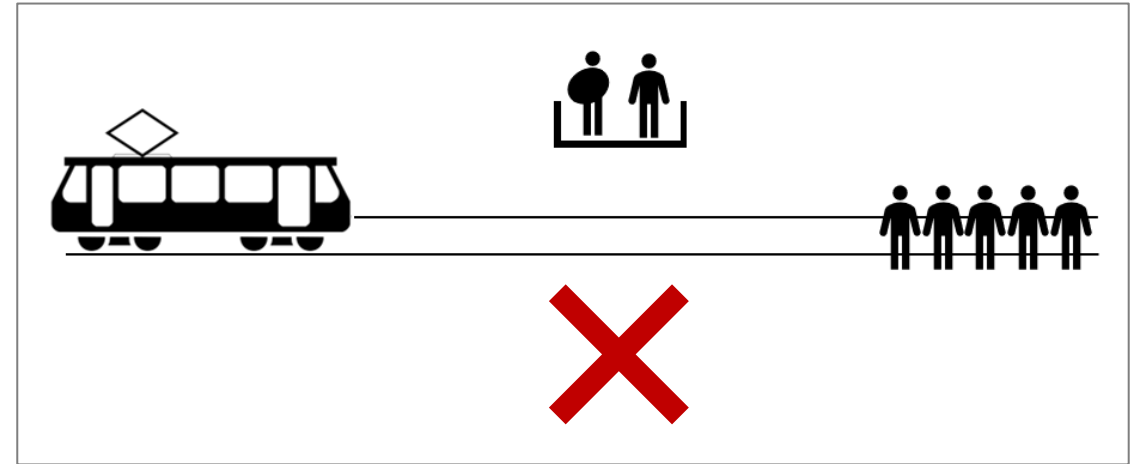
... until it becomes habit ... until we deeply understand what it means to live a ‘good life’

Golden mean ... the ‘middle way’ is likely to be virtuous

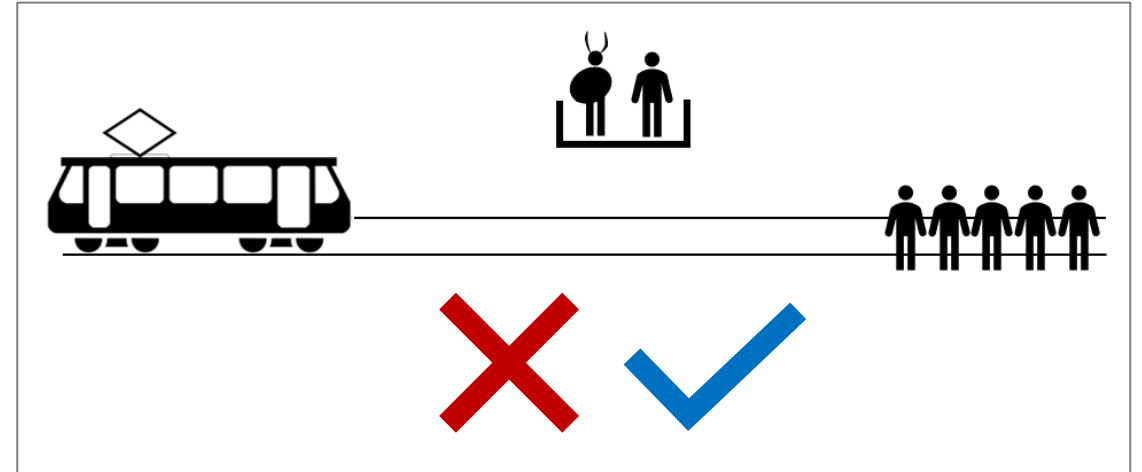
The Switch



The Fat Man



The Loved One



The Fat Villain

2. Deontology Immanuel Kant

Good actions are the ones that are consistent with moral duties

... without worrying about consequences, costs or benefits of doing so

We are bound by a universal law that doesn't allow for exceptions

“We should always keep our promises ... no matter what the personal cost”

“Every person has dignity ... and we should not treat people as a means to an end”

It is about the will to do what is right simply because it is right

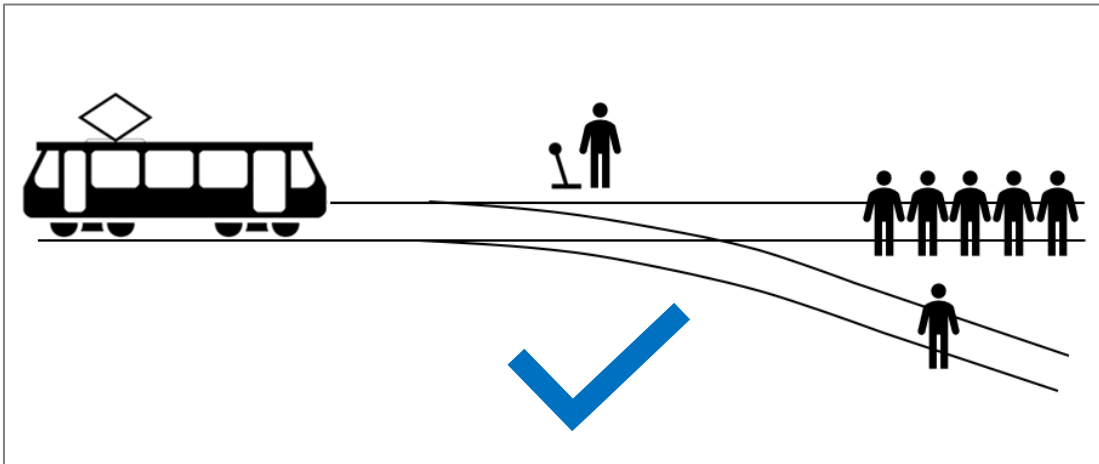
... not because it will feel good or produce the best outcome

We shouldn't make special exceptions for ourselves or others

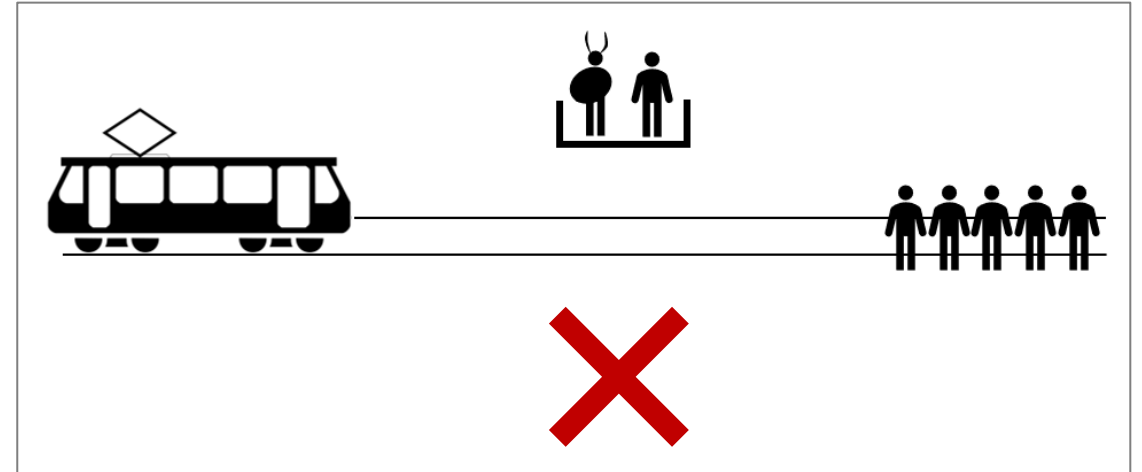
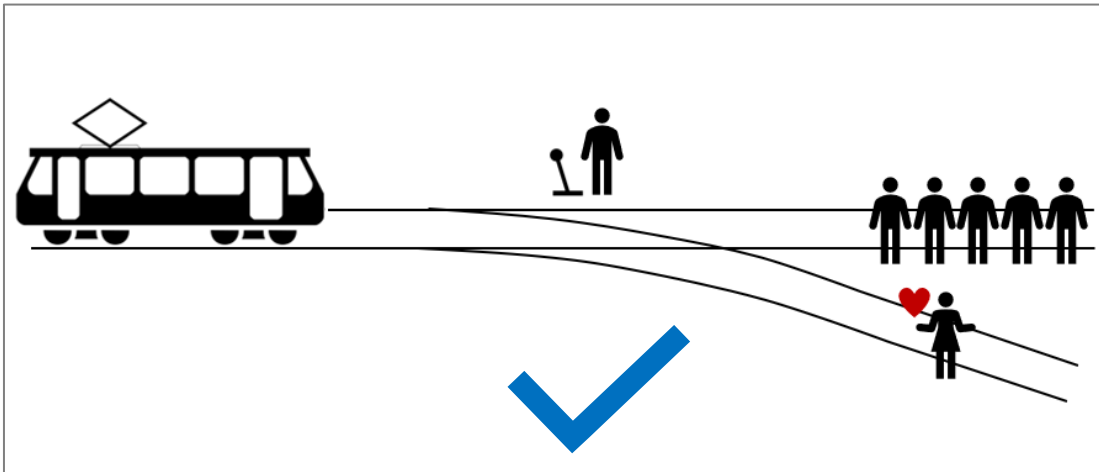
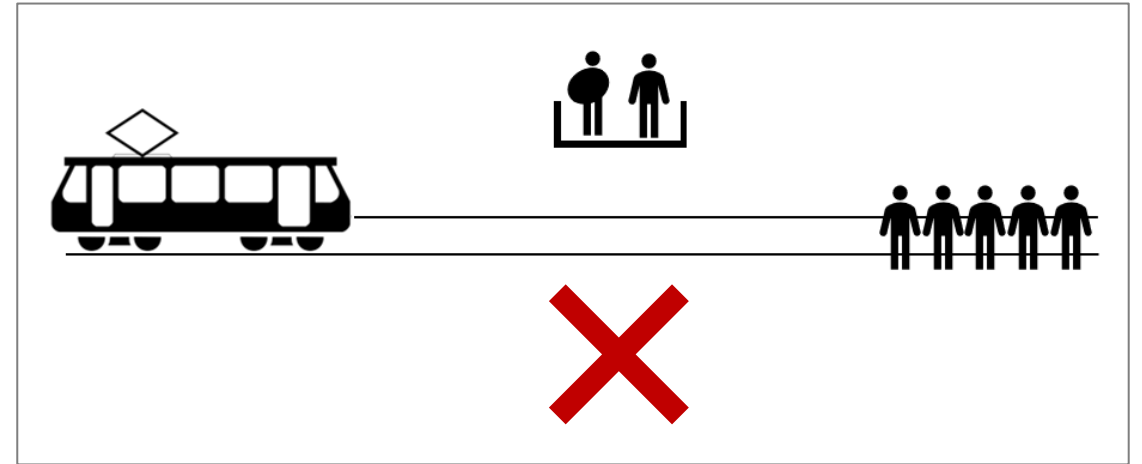
Deontology is derived from the Greek word for duty (deon) and science (logos)

The Ethics Centre (2020), 'Deontology' on Youtube

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3. Consequentialism Bentham and Mill

Good actions are the ones that have the best outcomes

Egoism focuses on what is best for me

Utilitarianism focuses on what is best for everyone

1. Maximise overall pleasure and minimise overall pain for everyone (Bentham)
2. Maximising overall benefits and minimising overall harm for everyone (Mill)
3. Maximising justice and minimising injustice (Moore)
4. Satisfaction of preferences

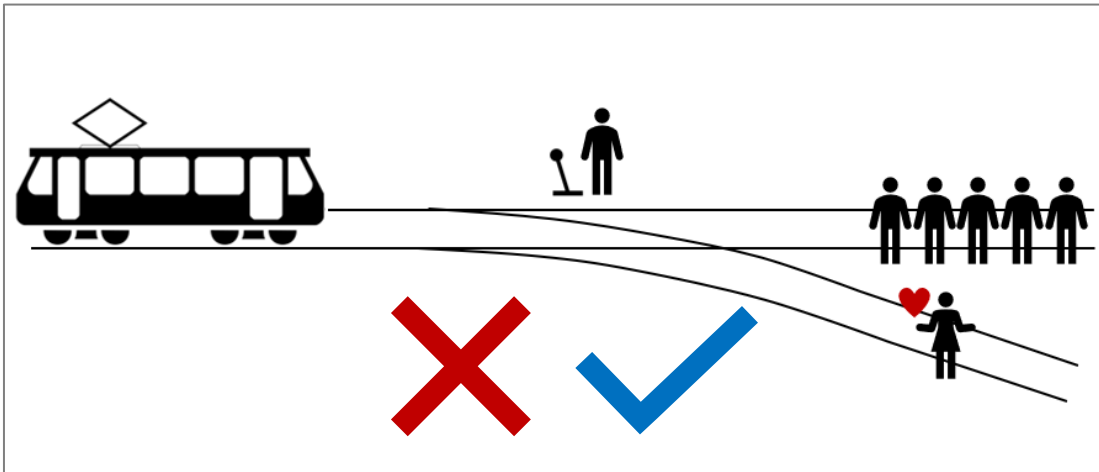
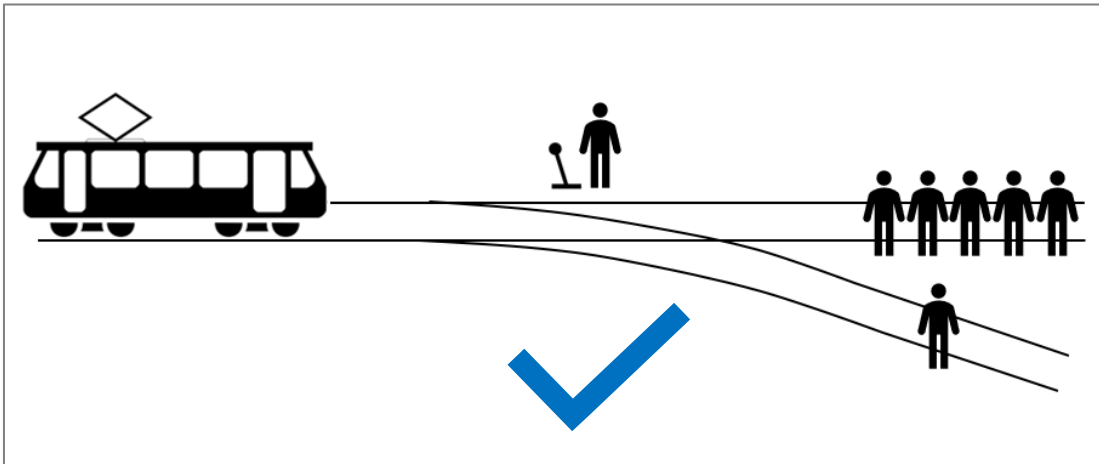
Work out actions that will result in best outcomes

... and then turn those into rules (rule utilitarianism)

Consequentialism argues that “the ends justifies the means”

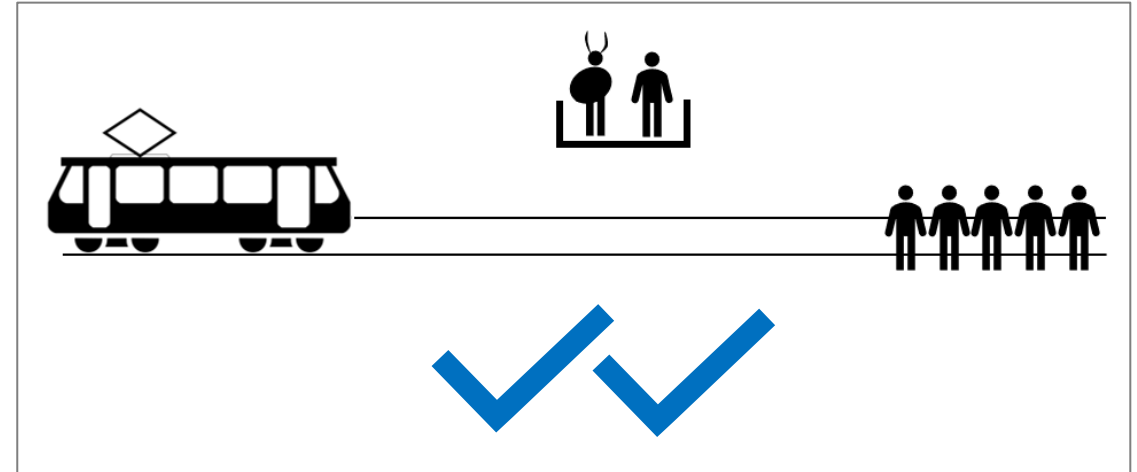
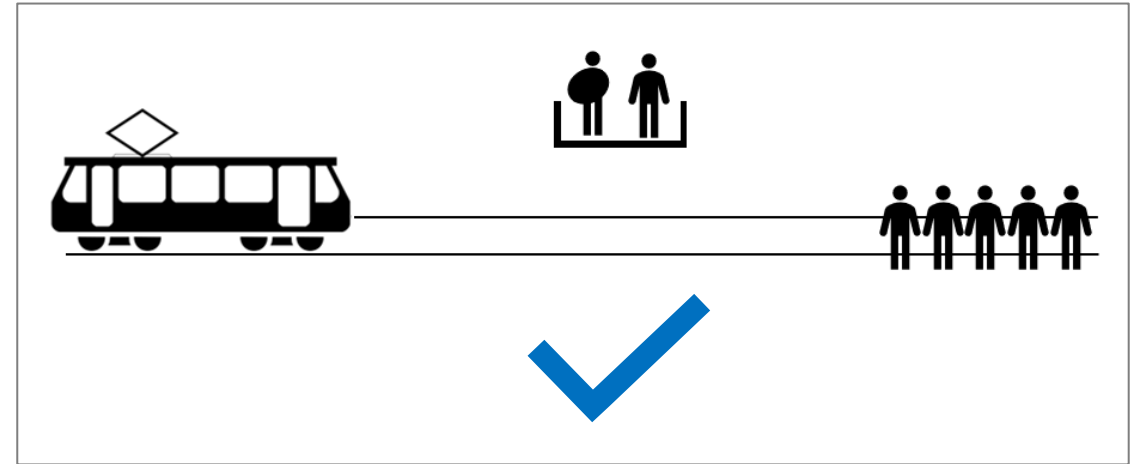
Is oppressing or exploiting a minority okay for the common good?

The Switch



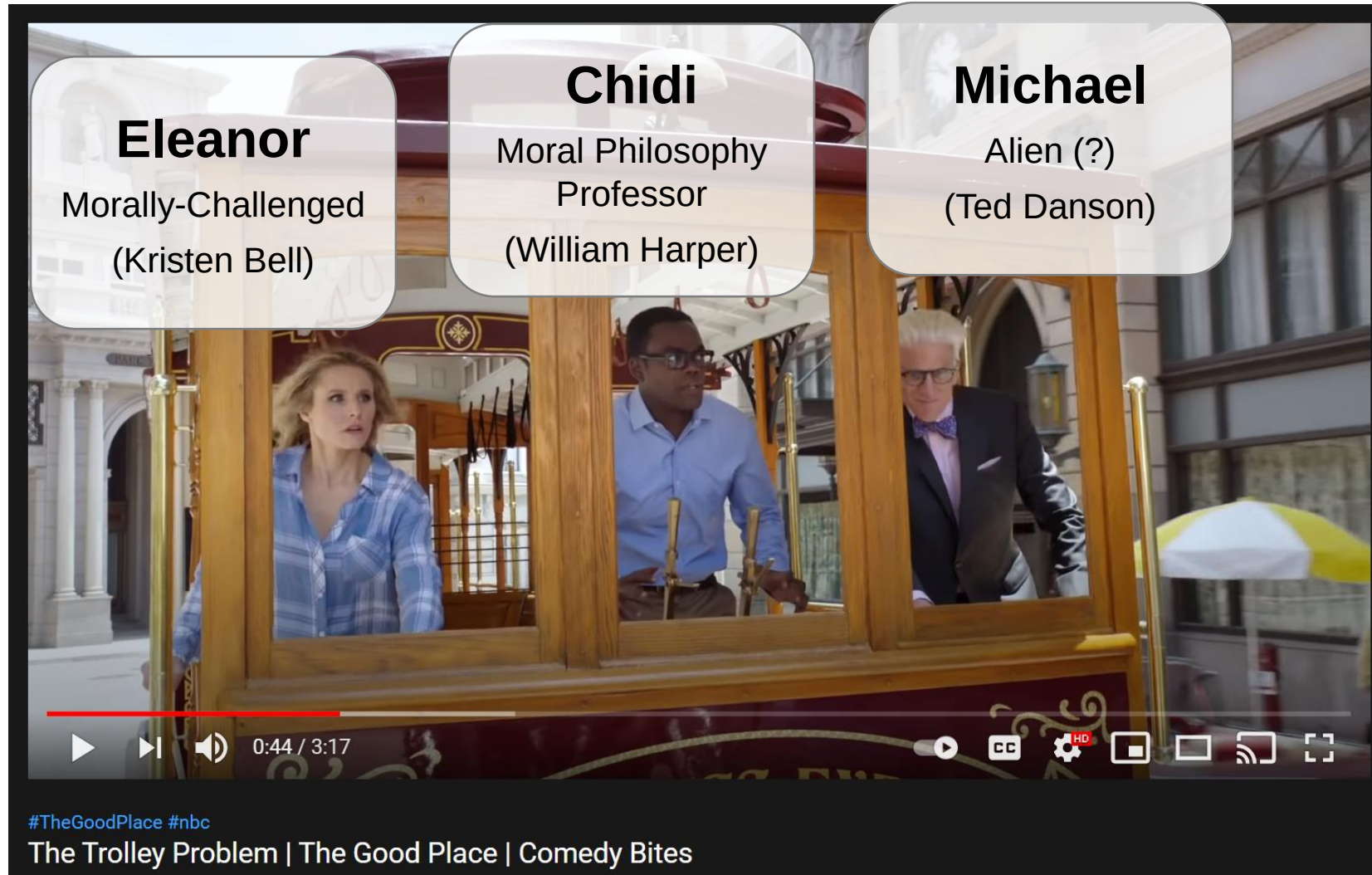
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